

APRIL 2025



INDIVIDUALIZED INITIAL COUNSELING RESOURCE GUIDE

Insert Location

Address

Phone number

Site Email Address

Site Social Media URL



Access website by clicking on the images above.

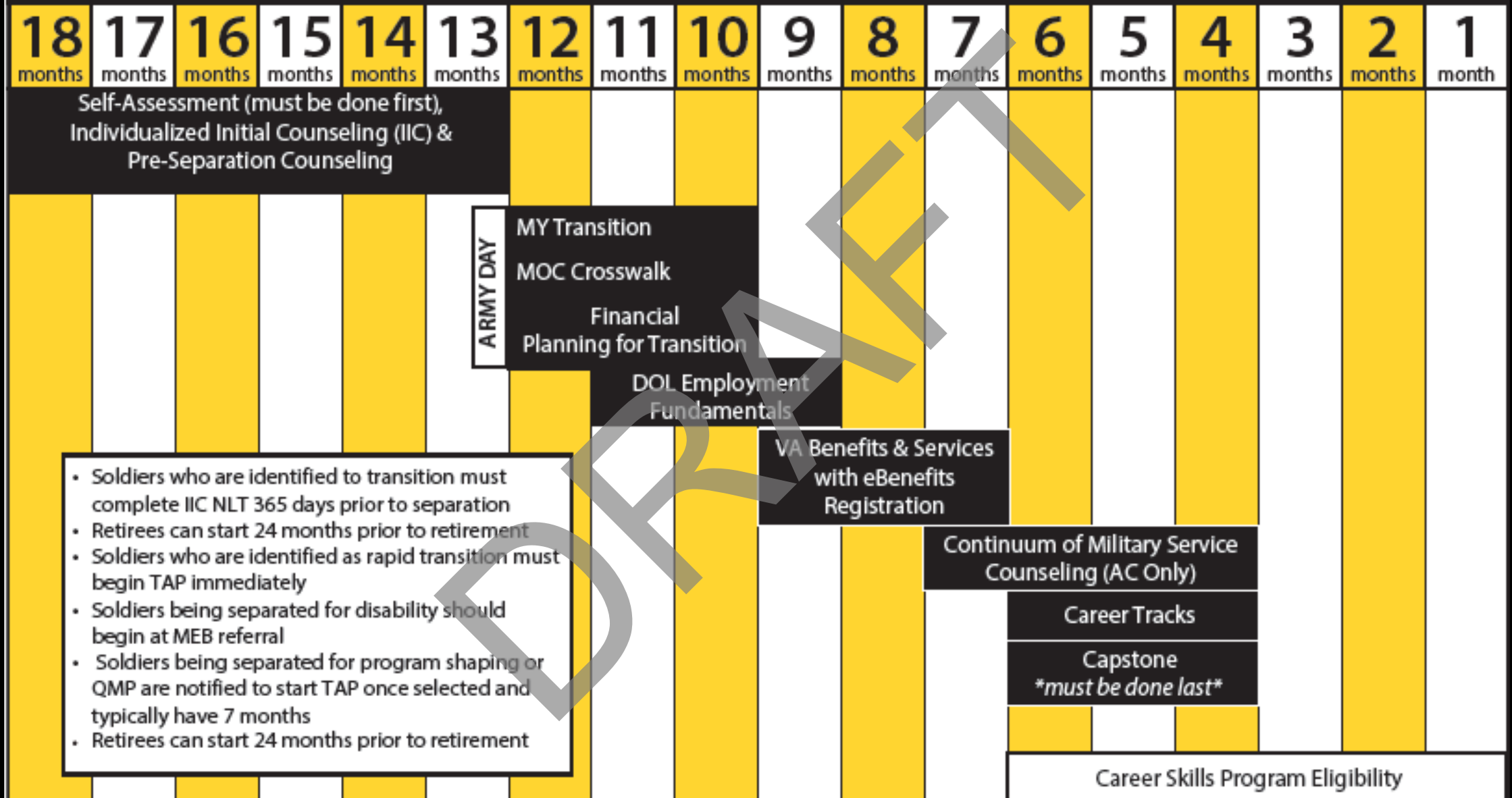
DISCLAIMER

The information provided herein does not constitute a formal endorsement of any company, its products, or services by the U.S. Department of Defense (DoD). Specifically, the appearance or use of external hyperlinks does not constitute endorsement by the DoD of the linked websites, or the information, products, or services contained therein. The DoD does not exercise any editorial control over the information you may find at these locations. While this information provides informational resource material to assist military personnel and their families in identifying or exploring resources and options, the resources provided are not exhaustive.

All websites and URLs in this guide were active at the date of publication. However, web content is subject to change without notice. Users of this guide are advised to confirm information is current.

The Army Transition Timeline

Time Before Transition Date



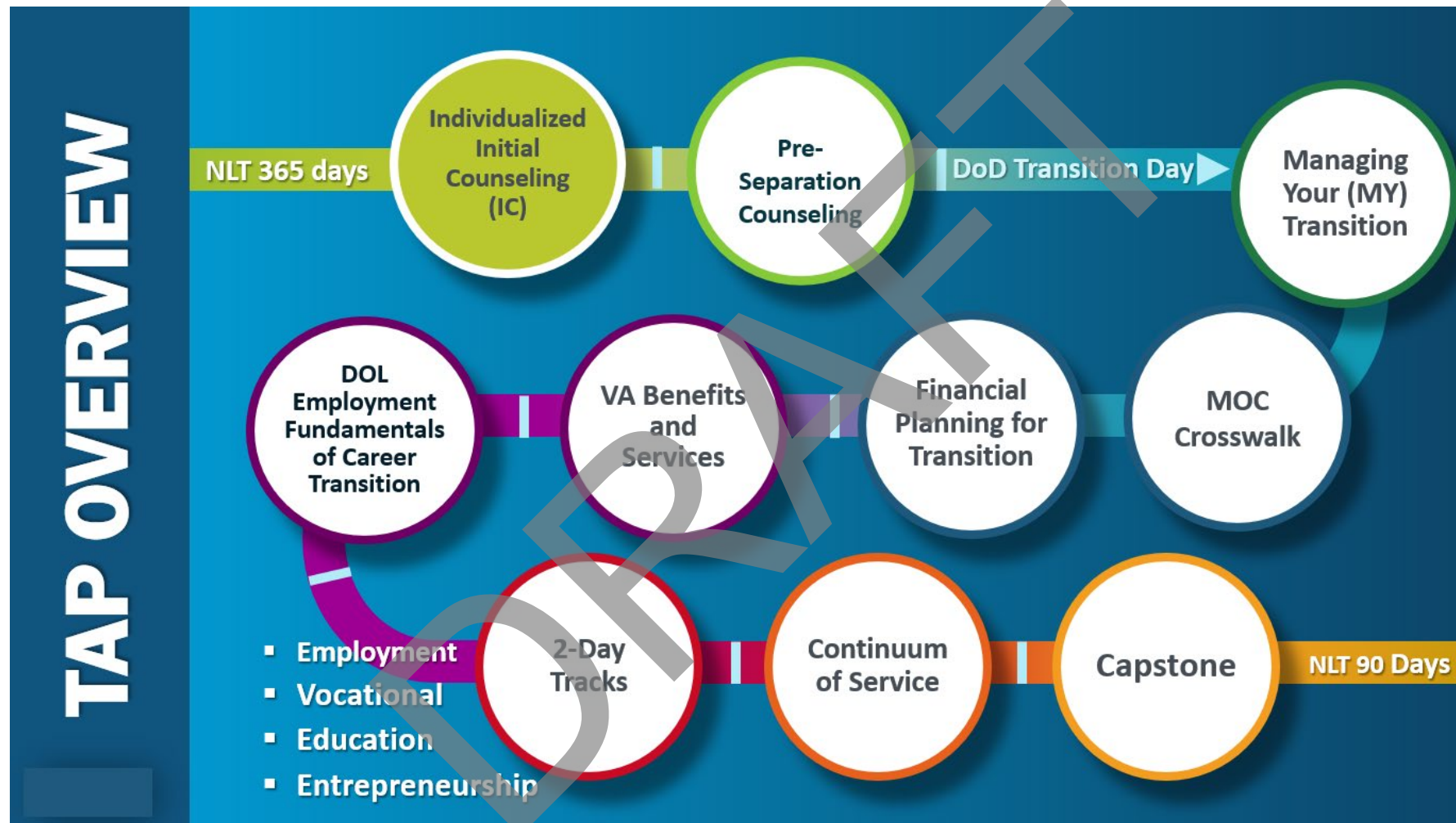
- Soldiers who are identified to transition must complete IIC NLT 365 days prior to separation
- Retirees can start 24 months prior to retirement
- Soldiers who are identified as rapid transition must begin TAP immediately
- Soldiers being separated for disability should begin at MEB referral
- Soldiers being separated for program shaping or QMP are notified to start TAP once selected and typically have 7 months
- Retirees can start 24 months prior to retirement

TAP services represented here can be accessed face-to-face at your local TAP Center, through Army TAP Virtual Center (www.armytap.army.mil) or at 800.325.4715

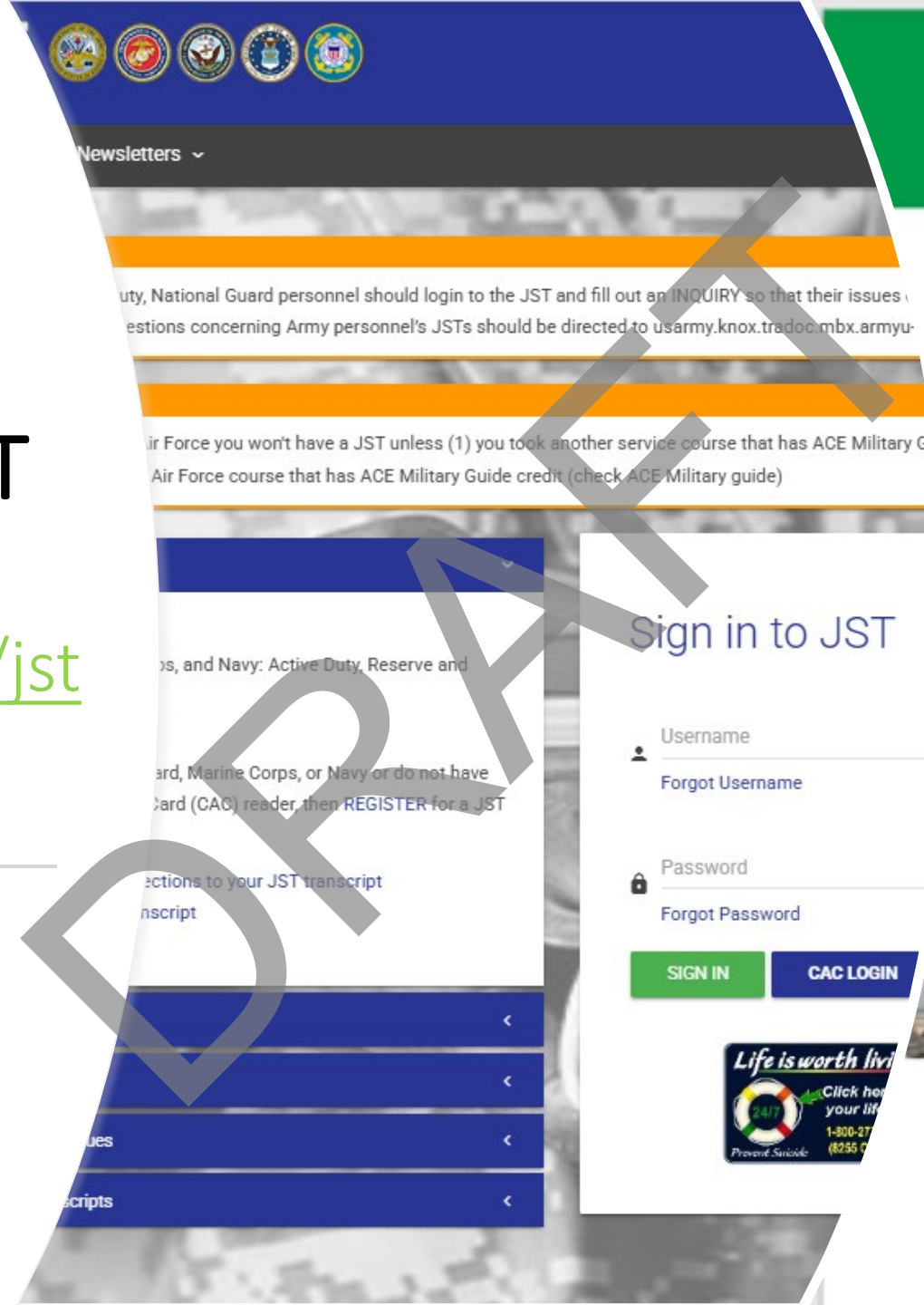
WHAT DOES TAP OFFER?



YOUR TAP OVERVIEW



To access your JST
go to
<https://jst.doded.mil/jst>



Joint Services Transcript



Sign in to JST

Username

[Forgot Username](#)

Password

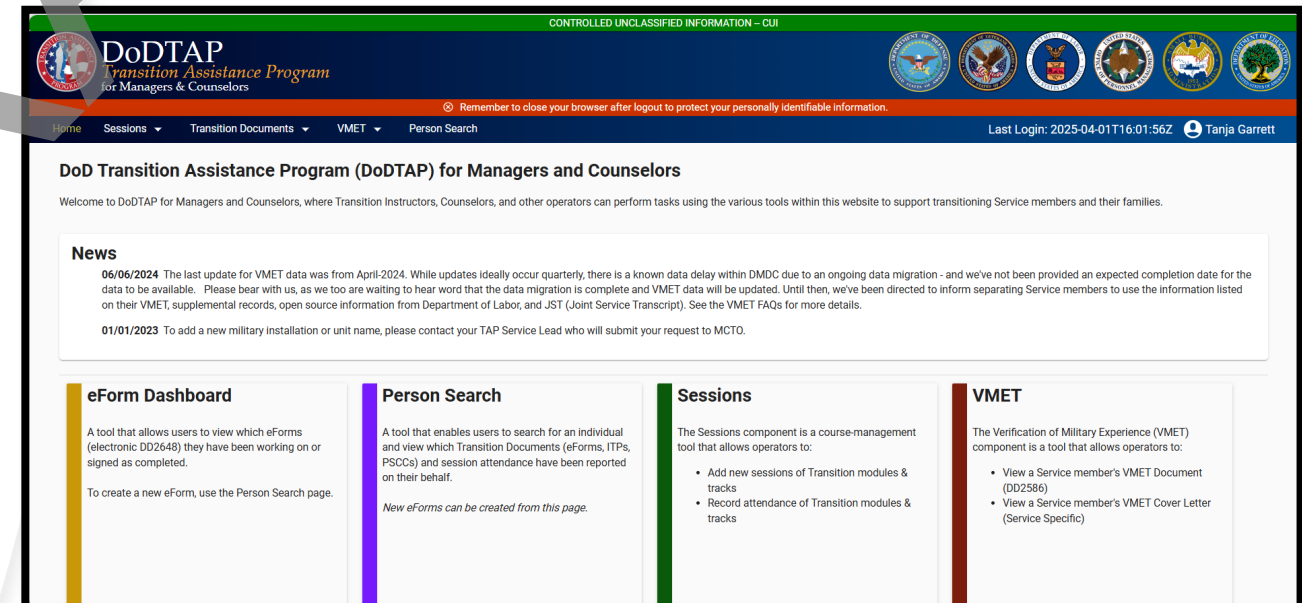
[Forgot Password](#)

[SIGN IN](#) [CAC LOGIN](#)



Website: <https://jst.doded.mil/jst>

Sign into DoDTAP to access your VMET
<https://dodtap.mil/dodtap/app/home>



To access One Stop Enrollment, go to
<https://www.careeronestop.org/>

careeronestop
your source for career exploration, training & jobs
Sponsored by the U.S. Department of Labor. A proud partner of the **americanjobcenter** network.

Login Español
Search

Explore Careers Find Training Job Search Find Local Help Toolkit Resources For

Explore career options
[Assessments](#)
[Career videos](#)
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Find training and education
[Schools and programs](#)
[Scholarships](#)
[Certifications](#)

Job search planning
[Resumes](#)
[Interviews](#)
[Job Finder](#)

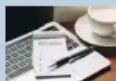
Find local help and services
[American Job Centers](#)
[Unemployment](#)
[Specialized programs](#)

Resources for
Find career, training and job search resources just for you.

55+ Workers Young Adults Justice-Impacted Job Seekers Veterans Employers
New Graduates People with Disabilities Military Spouses Career Changers Career Advisors

How-to Guides
[How to find career ideas](#)
Career assessments to help you find your best career fit.
[How to find a job now](#)
Need to focus on your job search? Six simple steps.
[How to recover after a layoff](#)
File for unemployment and other benefits and find your next job.
[View More](#)

Top Questions
1. [What's a CareerOneStop user account?](#)
2. [What are some high-pay jobs?](#)
3. [Where can I get help looking for a job?](#)
4. [How can I get started with self-employment?](#)
5. [How do I search for remote jobs?](#)
[View More](#)

Top News
**March 6, 2025**
[Spring job search refresh: Start targeting employers](#)
**February 6, 2025**
[Find technical training near you](#)
**January 2, 2025**
[Ready to explore career options in the new year?](#)
December 5, 2024



PARTNERSHIP for YOUR SUCCESS

CONNECTING AMERICA WITH ITS ARMY

PaYS offers Soldiers the opportunity to select up to five companies for a guaranteed job interview during transition from the Army to the civilian workforce.

This program is available to

ALL SOLDIERS –

Active Duty, Army Reserve and
Army National Guard.



If you are retiring or separating, click on the QR code to select your partners for a guaranteed interview!



TACTICAL EMPLOYMENT CONNECTIONS



Access website by clicking on the image above.

American Job Centers (AJCs) provide free help to job seekers for a variety of career and employment-related needs. Nearly 2,400 AJCs, funded by the U.S. Department of Labor's Employment and Training Administration, are located throughout the United States.



Access website by clicking on the image above.

TAP maximizes resources within the Regular Army, National Guard and Army Reserve regardless of where a Soldier is stationed. TAP offers Soldiers more opportunities as they transition from Active Duty to civilian life through the Reserve Component Career Counselor (RCCC) office. The goal is to connect transitioning Soldiers with local resources and employers in the community they will reside in post-transition to obtain meaningful employment. Employer Support of the Guard and Reserve



Access website by clicking on the image above.

Army TAP Centers enable Face-to-Face and virtual events during which transitioning Soldiers can meet formally with employers offering jobs, which may fit the Soldiers' skills, experience, and desires. Contact your local TAP office today and ask about their next Hiring Event

Scan QR Code to
access
TAP Events



Access website by clicking on the image above.

<https://www.armytap.army.mil/content/Tactical%20Employment%20Connection>



WHY CREATE A PROFILE WITH RECRUITMILITARY?

With ONE profile you get immediate access to military exclusive services:

- 24/7 Access to 300K+ Job Openings
- Virtual & In-Person Hiring Events
- Placement Services

Connect and Network with employers that want to hire YOU!



RecruitMilitary | Tactical Connection Program

Empowering the Military Community Through Meaningful Employment Opportunities



RMvets.com/WelcomeTAP

RecruitMilitary is the selected employment service provider to the U.S. Army and the Transition Assistance Program

Access website by clicking on the image above.

ABOUT THE PROGRAM

DoD SkillBridge programs provide our retiring and transitioning Service members the opportunity to participate in industry training programs while transitioning out of their Military careers.

The DoD covers Military pay and benefits during a Service member's time in a SkillBridge program, providing an invaluable experience for the Service member and the Industry Partner.

Program partners include employers in all career fields such as **Amazon, John Deere, Lockheed Martin, UnitedHealth Group,** and the **U.S. Veterans Administration** — and hundreds more!

PLAN FOR YOUR FUTURE

Career and transition planning is important to your success and begins with basic training. Just as military occupational training is mission-critical to your Service, continual career tooling is critical to your occupational success.

The DoD SkillBridge program is an excellent opportunity as you plan for your life after the military. SkillBridge matches civilian opportunities to your job training and work experience at the end of your military duty.

You may be eligible to participate in SkillBridge if you have 180 days of service or fewer remaining prior to your date of separation and you have at least 180 continuous days of active service.

GET ENGAGED

Your installation transition support office can help you with your transition plan and future career aspirations for a successful transition from your military career to your future civilian career.

- Review your career and transition plan and discuss your career aspirations
- Sign up for Transition Assistance Program (TAP) trainings
- See if there is a SkillBridge program that can help in your next career



LEVERAGE YOUR BENEFITS

In addition to opportunities such as Tuition Assistance and the GI Bill program, you can enhance your marketability and post-separation career prospects by participating in a SkillBridge opportunity.

The DoD also has several other programs available to help Service members meet career aspirations:

Credentialing Opportunities On-Line (COOL)

Access information for over 3,000 certifications, credentials, and licenses.

<http://bit.ly/dodcool1>

MilGears

Powered by COOL

A customized career navigation tool currently for Navy Service members with future support for all military Service members.

<http://bit.ly/milgears1>

United Services Military Apprenticeship Program (USMAP)

Join other Service members who are obtaining on-the-job career training.

STEP 1 » INITIAL COUNSELING (IC)
365 DAYS

STEP 2 » TRANSITION READINESS WORKSHOPS

STEP 3 » CAPSTONE REVIEW
90 DAYS

STEP 4 » COMMANDER'S VERIFICATION



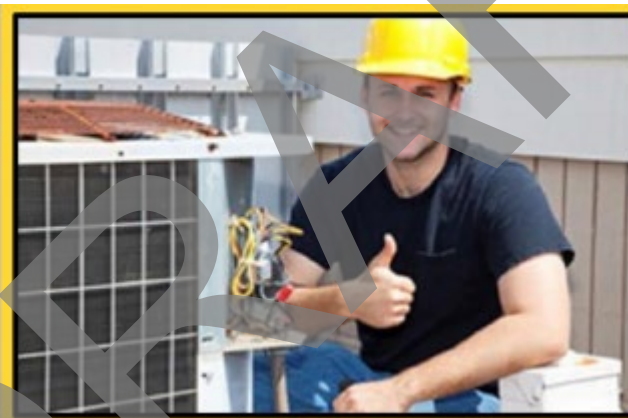
Career Skills Program

CREATE YOUR FUTURE

With The Army Career Skills Program (CSP)

BENEFITS

- ❖ **Guaranteed Job/Interview into an open position**
- ❖ **Builds upon skills acquired during military service**
- ❖ **Provides skills that relate to civilian occupation with industry recognized credentials**
- ❖ **A high probability of employment**
- ❖ **Pay commensurate with the knowledge, skills and abilities necessary to perform the job**



ELIGIBILITY

- ❖ **Must have 180 days of continuous active-duty service**
- ❖ **Anticipated discharge of release from active duty within 180 calendar days of the CSP start date (or upon completion of the MRDP and enrollment in IDES for MEB)**
- ❖ **Anticipated honorable or under honorable conditions discharge**
- ❖ **Approval authority is first field grade commander with UCMJ authority in the Soldier's chain of command**

For More Information About The Army's Career Skills Program Please Contact Your TAP Office

Career Skills Program, DoD SkillBridge Program and Individual Internship Program Structure

Three-category structure:

Category	Rank	Number of Days	Approval Authority
Category I	E1-E5	Up to 120 days	First field grade Commander with UCMJ
Category II	E6-E7, WO1-CW3, and O1-O3	Up to 90 days	First O6 CDR Commander with UCMJ
Category III	E8-E9, CW4-CW5, O4 and above	Up to 60 days	First General Officer in the Soldier's Chain of Command



Career Skills Program

Access website by clicking on the image above.

**This slide is included for sites to add Service-specific
information about their local CSP TAP Office**

Along with the CSP CO Name and direct email address.

If your site does not have a CSP CO please add the CIM or who ever has been coordinated to support your site.

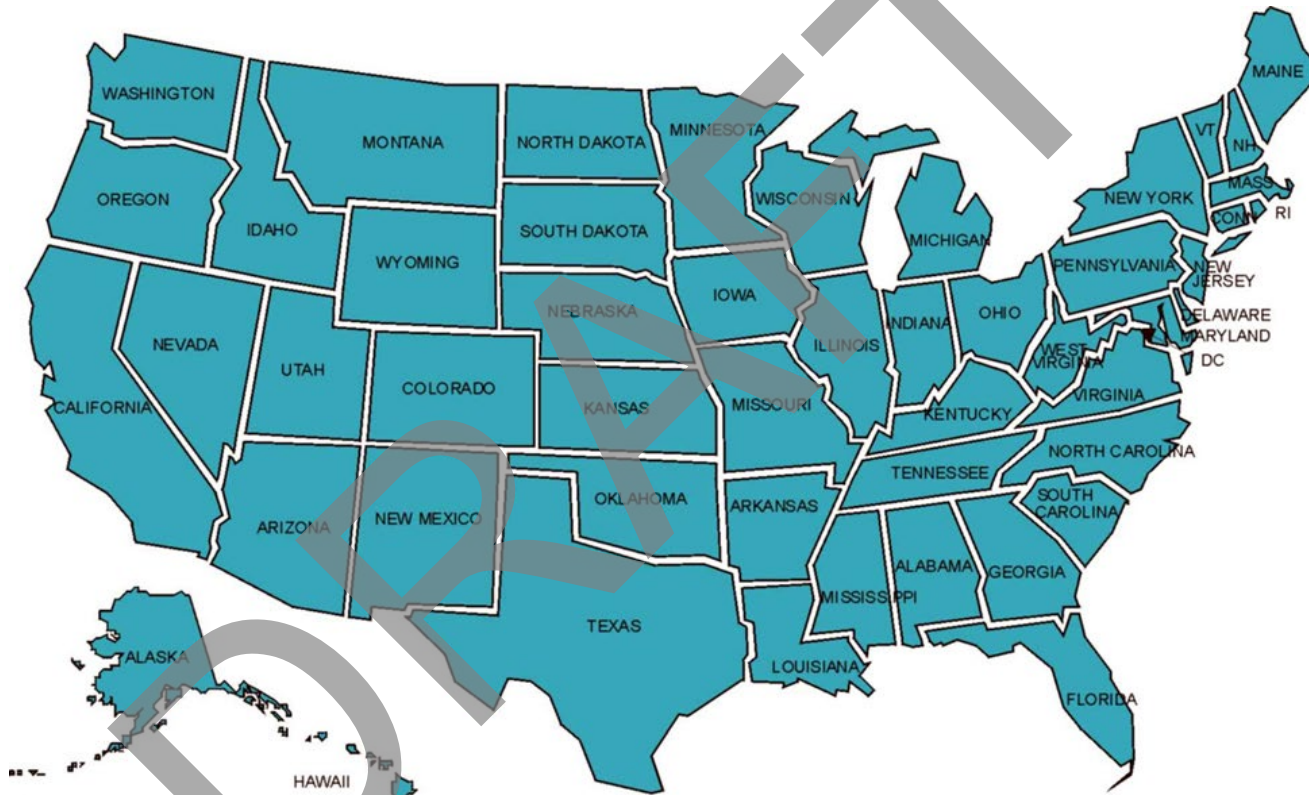
NOTE: This slide should no longer be hidden

For More Information About The Army's Career Skills Program Please Contact Your TAP Office



Unemployment Compensation (UCX) for Ex-Service Members

Access website by clicking on the image above.



The Unemployment Compensation for Ex-servicemembers (UCX) program provides benefits for eligible ex-military personnel. Unemployment compensation provides weekly income for a limited period of time. Additional information covering unemployment compensation for veterans can be found under the U.S. Department of Labor (DOL) at <http://oui.doleta.gov/unemploy/ucx.asp>.

Eligibility varies from state to state, so go to your state's Workforce Services website at <https://www.careeronestop.org/LocalHelp/service-locator.aspx> for up-to-date information about the unemployment insurance program in your state and how to file a claim.

INDIVIDUAL TRANSITION PLAN (ITP)

The key to a successful transition is planning, which requires a carefully thought-out Individual Transition Plan (ITP).

The ITP provides a framework to achieve realistic career goals based upon an assessment of your personal and family needs as well as your unique skills, knowledge, experience, interests and abilities.

SECTION I.

Identify
Post-transition
Personal/Family
Requirements

- Taking Care of Individual/Family Needs
- Assessing Benefits and Entitlements
- Getting Financially Ready

If you are preparing for transition, ask yourself the following three questions and prioritize what is most important to you:

Where do you and your family want to live?

What career do you want to pursue?

What is your desired income?

POST-TRANSITION PLANS

Section I. Identify Post-transition Personal/Family Requirements

A. Taking Care of Individual/Family Member Needs

- ☐ Identify individual/family needs such as medical care, expenses, and location of potential providers.
 - o Schedule final physical (SHPE or SHA) and dental checkups and speak with your Tricare representative about Transitional Healthcare Benefits. Visit www.healthcare.gov to evaluate costs of health insurance.
- ☐ Identify extenuating individual/family circumstances (e.g. need to provide care for elderly parents, family business, exceptional family member needs, etc.).
- ☒ Assess impact of individual/family requirements on relocation options (e.g. quality of local schools, availability of medical care, spouse employment opportunities, etc.).
- ☐ Evaluate your immediate post-transition housing requirements.
 - o Determine living space needed. Consider making more than one move or utilizing temporary storage.
 - o Contact the housing referral office to set up transportation counseling. The installation transportation office can provide detailed information about planning the movement and storage of your household goods.
 - o Visit the VA website: <https://www.va.gov/housing-assistance/home-loans/> to get information on the VA home loan guaranty program.
- ☐ Consider your post-transition transportation requirements.
 - o Determine what reliable transportation can take you to and from work or school.
 - o Evaluate your commuting options.
 - o Determine transportation needs for spouse and/or dependents.
 - o Identify your post-transition transportation expenses to include: purchase costs, vehicle registration, insurance, maintenance, fuel, etc.
 - o If you are disabled, determine if you are eligible for assistance in purchasing a vehicle and/or automotive adaptive equipment by visiting: <https://www.va.gov/disability/eligibility/special-claims/automobile-allowance-adaptive-equipment/>
- ☐ Evaluate if the thought of leaving the military creates increased feelings of stress or anxiety on you and your family.
- ☐ Consider your support system.
 - o Who do you go to for advice, personal counsel and/or mentoring in a difficult challenge or decision?
 - o Will you still have access to those persons after you transition from active duty?
 - o Determine what steps you need to take now to maintain contact and continue those relationships.
 - o Determine how to establish this type of support in the community where you will live.

Create and maintain your ITP with assistance from your Transition Counselor

INDIVIDUAL TRANSITION PLAN (ITP)

SECTION II.

Evaluate Military and Civilian Experience and Training

- Documenting Job Related Training
- Verifying Eligibility for Licensure and Certification
- Identify career field(s) you are qualified to enter



JST

A list of completed military education and training which provides credit recommendations, course hours, and descriptions.

Access website by clicking on the image above.

milConnect

Verification of Military Experience and Training (VMET), DD Form 2586

A useful document to have during transition that provides documentation and verifies military experience and training.

Access website by clicking on the image above.



Community College of the Air Force (CCAF)

A regionally accredited college, sharing in Air University's accreditation through the Southern Association of Colleges and Schools-Commission on Colleges (SACSCOC).

Access website by clicking on the image above.

Section II. Evaluate Military and Civilian Experience and Training

A. Documenting Job Related Training

- ☐ List the documentation of your civilian and military experience/training (e.g., certifications, diplomas, transcripts, licenses, etc.) that you need to gather for resume development. This may require research on your behalf to contact former technical training and academic institutions to identify their specific procedures and any applicable fees for providing this service.

☐	☐
☐	☐
☐	☐

- ☐ Verify your military experience and training (VMET) at: www.dodtap.mil/login.html. Assistance is available by meeting with a Transition Counselor and instruction is available by attending the MOS Crosswalk Course. Review the list of schools documented on the VMET site. If necessary, gather documentation and list below all military professional development schools you completed that are missing from the VMET site.

☐	☐
☐	☐

B. Verify Eligibility for Licensure and Credentialing

- ☐ Crosswalk your military skill set to the corresponding civilian AND identify and document transferable credits earned through your military experience and training and verify your eligibility for licensure, certification and apprenticeship programs.

C. Identify career field(s) you are qualified to enter.

- ☐ Conduct personal research to explore and evaluate potential career field options.
- ☐ Refine your research to identify desired industries, careers, jobs and salaries. Consider the public and private sectors. Identify any prerequisites you would have to complete (e.g., education, training, certification, licensure, security clearance) before being fully qualified to seek employment.
- Now that you identified potential careers, evaluate your ease to relocate and find new employment. Find where opportunities exist by researching employment websites such as: <https://www.usajobs.gov/> and American Job Centers <https://www.careeronestop.org/Site/american-job-center.aspx>
 - Now that you know where potential jobs exist, research those locations to determine if they meet your personal/family requirements. Explore state, city and county websites to evaluate demographics, school ratings, tax rates, cost of living, availability of housing, home prices, etc. Assistance is also available through your installation relocation assistance office and through the U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics: <https://www.bls.gov/data/>

Create and maintain your ITP with assistance from your Transition Counselor

INDIVIDUAL TRANSITION PLAN (ITP)

SECTION III.

Determine
Post-transition
Career Track(s)

- Finding a New Job
- Continuing Your Education
- Pursuing Vocational Training
- Starting a Business

- Employment
- Vocational
- Education
- Entrepreneurship

2-Day
Tracks

Section III. Determine Post-transition Career Track

A. Designate the career field you wish to pursue based on your personal, family and financial obligations and desires.

Identify desired Career Field(s): _____

Identify desired Relocation Destination(s): _____

B. Designate your transition track.

❖ Select the transition track(s) you wish to pursue. Use the statements below each track to help you determine which step(s) to take next.

☐ Employment

- I require additional assistance to further explore future employment opportunities.
- I need to write/update my resume.
- I need to learn more about networking, interviewing, and job search prep.

☐ Education

- I require additional education in my desired career field.
- I plan to enroll in college or university.
- I plan to obtain professional licensure or certification.

☐ Vocational

- I require additional vocational training in my desired career field.
- I plan to enroll in vocational training or apprenticeship.
- I plan to obtain professional licensure or certification.

☐ Entrepreneurship

- I require additional SBA training to start my own business.
- I need to begin or complete a business plan.

☐ Other

- I am fully qualified to seek immediate employment in my desired career field and am ready to apply to the position I want.
- I have been offered a job that meets my post-transition personal/family/financial obligations and relocation plans.
- I currently already have the position I want in my desired career field.
- I currently or will be enrolled in a higher education or vocational institute.
- I currently own my own business or will be taking over a family business.

Check-In:

- ☐ I have been assigned a Tier
- ☐ I understand my Career Readiness Standards and the deliverables associated with my Career track(s)
- ☐ I have attended Pre-Separation Counseling and I do not have any follow-on questions
- ☐ I have selected a Career Track(s)
- ☐ I have been scheduled for additional classes or follow-up counseling(s) and have received my

Create and maintain your ITP with assistance from your Transition Counselor

INSTALLATION TAP LEADERSHIP

This slide is included for sites to add TAP LEADERSHIP contact information

DELETE slide if not in use

Transition Service Manager

Enter Name

Enter Phone / Email

Transition Service Specialist

Enter Name

Enter Phone / Email

Contractor Installation Manager

Enter Name

Enter Phone / Email

INSTALLATION RESOURCES

This slide is included for sites to add Service-specific information about their local RCCC / RETENTION / HIRING / TAP OFFICE procedures, etc.

DELETE slide if not in use

May insert additional slides if necessary

REMINDER:

Pre-Transition Questionnaire

- Now that you have completed your IIC, please complete the Pre-Transition Questionnaire on the Soldier portal.
- <https://armytap.appsplatformportals.us/signin?ReturnUrl=%2F>

Your Success Story Starts Here

THANK YOU FOR YOUR SERVICE!

NEXT STEP

PRE-SEPARATION COUNSELING

Introduction to benefits and entitlements you may have earned during your military Service
Program information that will assist in transition

Your Success Story Starts Here

THANK YOU FOR YOUR SERVICE!